USING DATA TO DRIVE BUSINESS PERFORMANCE · PREPARED FOR CENGAGE · OCTOBER 2026

Full market research

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Online version: https://database-textbook.dimapublishing.com/cengage-prospectus-oyb70aaf/

THE RESEARCH BEHIND THE COURSEWARE

Market research

How the market research was done

What we reviewed	Federal degree statistics (NCES, and IPEDS completions through Data USA), peer-reviewed studies of business and IS curricula, AACSB accreditation data, U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics projections, the World Economic Forum's employer survey, and a published analysis of U.S. data analyst job postings. Our own syllabus research, below, adds the textbook and AI-policy findings.
How	We retained published figures with their source years, separated degree counts from course and program evidence, and combined two of them into illustrative reach proxies. Each proxy is shown with its assumptions and would need publisher validation.
What we looked for	How many students take a course like this each year, which programs require it, what employers ask for, and whether any textbook already dominates the course.

Finding 1: a large, required course

375,418
DEGREES, 2021–22

Business bachelor's degrees awarded in the U.S.

About one in five of all bachelor's degrees.

Source: NCES [1]

85%
OF 61 BUSINESS SCHOOLS

Require at least one information systems course in the business core

52 of 61 schools studied (89% of them AACSB-accredited); 3% required two IS courses.

Source: Fustos, Morris and Haga [2]

12,092
DEGREES IN 2024

Management information systems degrees awarded

Up 3.4% over the prior year. Counts all award levels reported, not only bachelor's degrees.

Source: Data USA [3]

87.3%
OF 394 IS PROGRAMS

Offer a data and information management course

344 of 394 U.S. undergraduate IS programs in business schools (data collected in 2013).

Source: Hwang, Ma and Wang [4]

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285 of 535
AACSB SCHOOLS

U.S. AACSB-accredited schools that offer an information systems program

A further 109 offer an undergraduate business analytics program (Table 2).

Source: Zheng et al. [5]

82%
OF 74 IS MASTER'S PROGRAMS

Require a data, information and content management course

61 of 74 programs at AACSB schools: a graduate audience for the same material.

Source: Yang [6]

81,835
DEGREES IN 2024

Accounting degrees awarded, an adjacent audience

Accounting information systems courses cover much of the same ground. All award levels reported.

Source: Data USA [7]

1,098
INSTITUTIONS

AACSB-accredited institutions worldwide

In 71 countries and territories, as of September 2026.

Source: AACSB [8]

Award levels: the Data USA counts (MIS and accounting) are IPEDS completions across all award levels reported, not bachelor's degrees alone. The NCES figure counts bachelor's degrees only.

Two routes, one book

A commonality we found: **most business schools in the published studies require an information systems course of every business student, and most IS programs offer a database course.** The proposed routes address these two settings; fit must be reviewed against each course's outcomes and available teaching time. In round numbers:

About 320,000
ILLUSTRATIVE REACH PROXY

Business students who reach a required IS course

375,418 business bachelor's degrees (2021–22) × the 85% of business schools that require at least one IS course (2017 study).

Source: Our estimate from [1], [2]

About 10,600
ILLUSTRATIVE REACH PROXY

MIS students in programs with a database course

12,092 MIS degrees across all award levels (2024) × the 87.3% of IS programs that offer the course (2015 study).

Source: Our estimate from [3], [4]

Planning assumptions: each proxy multiplies a degree count by a historical, program-level share from a different source year. They are not enrollment-weighted course-seat estimates, and the MIS count covers all award levels. The two audiences overlap and must not be added together. Publisher enrollment and adoption data are needed to estimate addressable annual seats.

Finding 2: a varied textbook landscape

60
TITLES

Textbooks named in the syllabi we reviewed

No title appeared at more than 3 of the 31 schools reviewed. Instructor-made materials also appear. This describes the reviewed collection, not national market share.

Source: Syllabus research, below

2021
LAST REVISION

Cengage's applied business-database title

Concepts of Database Management, 10th edition, is built on Access 2019 and SQL Server 2019. It has served the course well, and the tools and topics have moved on since.

Source: Cengage [13]

Adoption fit

Adoption fit is described qualitatively: which courses could use the courseware, what they need, and what a review should confirm. No revenue, seat or institution forecasts are made.

Segment	Likely need	Validation focus	Adoption opportunity
Primary Applied business database / MIS data management	Relational thinking, SQL, design, implementation, and business interpretation in one coherent learning path.	Course outcomes, required database engine, incumbent materials, and switching criteria.	Full courseware adoption with readings, guided practice, independent labs, assessment, and instructor resources.
Business core data / IS course	Data meaning, information systems, queries, reporting, and a bounded project.	Which chapters fit the existing course and how much SQL and design it expects.	The business-core route through the same chapters.
Accounting information systems	Data meaning, controls, reporting and integrity.	Which modules fit the existing course.	Modular adoption or a companion pathway, subject to course fit.
Business analytics foundations	Data preparation, trustworthy SQL measures, and reporting.	Required design depth, analytical prerequisites, and reporting platform.	A selected chapter and lab route that supplies the database foundation for analytics.

MAIN CONCLUSION

The evidence supports exploring two defined course routes: the applied business database / MIS course, which this book leads with, and the required business-core data / IS course. Their outcomes, tools and switching criteria should be validated separately.

SOURCES AND SCOPE

References

Market, employment and curriculum references

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